

RENEWABLES

China Brings 2.2-GW Solar Park



Darrell Proctor

Sunday, October 11, 2020

A Chinese company announced it has brought the **world's second-largest solar farm** into commercial operation. **Sungrow, which supplies inverters for renewable energy projects, and the state-owned utility Huanghe Hydropower Development** on Oct. 9 said a **2.2-GW capacity** solar park in the northwest province of Qinghai is now online.

The Qinghai project trails only the 2.3-GW Bhadla solar park in India, which covers more than 10,000 acres and was completed late last year, in generation capacity.

The largest operating solar farm in the U.S. is the 579-MW Solar Star installation in California, which came online in 2015 and at the time was the largest solar array in the world. A larger U.S. project, the 690-MW Gemini solar and battery storage installation in Nevada, was approved earlier this year and is scheduled to be operational by year-end 2023.

Site Includes Energy Storage

The Qinghai project, which also includes **202.86 MWh of energy storage capacity**, is located in the **desert near the city of Xining**. The installation, which was **completed in September**, is connected to an **800-kV transmission line that runs 986 miles from Qinghai across that province and three others—Gansu, Shaanxi, and Henan—and is expected to provide power to cities in the east and south of China, including Shanghai and Beijing**.



*This 2.2-GW solar farm in **Qinghai province** is now operational. It is the world's second-largest solar farm in terms of generation capacity. Courtesy: Sungrow*

Sungrow in a news release said, "The ultra-high voltage power line in China is set to maximize the consumption of renewable energy as the solar resources deployed unevenly by region, significantly fueling the transition

This website utilizes technologies such as cookies to enable essential site functionality, as well as for analytics, personalization, and targeted advertising. You may change your settings at any time or accept the default settings. You may close this banner to continue with only essential cookies.

[Privacy Policy](#)[Storage Preferences](#)☐ Targeted Advertising☐ Personalization☐ Analytics

Save

Accept All

Reject Non-Essential

WEBINARS

Creating Value from Data: Maximizing Plant Performance Through Real-Time Analytics

JULY 9 • 2 PM ET

[Register Now](#)

July 9, 2025

Creating Value from Data: Maximizing Plant Performance Through Real-Time Analytics

Modern process industries are experiencing fluctuating market conditions and tight operational margins, leading chemical engineers to rely on rea...

REGISTER Sponsored by **DATAPARC**

June 16, 2025

Smart MRO: Using Technology and Assessment to Enhance Power Plant Performance

to a low carbon economy for eastern China and facilitating the western economic growth.”

The Chinese government has a plan to build what it calls the world’s largest supergrid, connecting six regional grids in the country and carrying power from renewable resources in the western part of the country to the east. Chinese President Xi Jinping in September, [in an address to the United Nations](#) during Climate Week NYC 2020, said he wants China to be carbon-neutral by 2060, although the country [continues to build new coal-fired power plants](#).

According to [Global Energy Monitor](#), China in 2020 has proposed to build more than 40 GW of new coal-fired units.

\$5 Trillion in Clean Energy Investment

Analysts have said China, the world’s leading emitter of carbon, will need to invest more than \$5 trillion in cleaner energy and carbon-reduction technologies to meet its 2060 target.

Developers of renewable energy projects in China are ramping up efforts to move their installations forward. Delays from the coronavirus pandemic have slowed the [government’s plan to have solar and wind power compete](#) with coal generation on prices.

Sungrow, founded in 1997, said its inverters are installed in projects with more than 120 GW of generation capacity worldwide, including utility-scale, commercial, and residential arrays. The company said it has a global solar market share of more than 15%.

Huanghe Hydropower is a leading renewable energy company in China, and has led the country’s innovation of solar-plus-storage technology. A Huanghe spokesperson, commenting on the Qinghai project, said, “We value Sungrow’s compelling global PV [photovoltaic] and energy storage track records and professionalism of the team. In this landmark project, Sungrow is the first-ever company to pass the functional test of the synergizing control of both PV and energy storage system in regard of the energy management system.”

—**Darrell Proctor** is associate editor for *POWER* ([@POWERmagazine](#)).

TAGGED IN: [Solar](#) // [Sungrow](#) // [Huanghe Hydropower Development](#)

REGISTER 

Sponsored by **RENTECH**

May 20, 2025

How One Electric Utility Is Using AI and Extreme Weather Modeling to Make Critical Grid Decisions

REGISTER 

Sponsored by **TECHNOSYLVA**

VIDEOS



Data Center POWER eXchange 2025 Recap

The inaugural Data Center POWER eXchange brought the data center power ecosystem together in Denver for a focused, one-day summit on the infrastructure shaping the future of digital growth. From site selection and development to operations and forward planning, DPX connected leaders across data center ownership, utilities, engineering, power generation, and technology. Watch to see [...]

POWER

archives + podcasts +
webinars + e-letters +
video + exclusive content +
events + much more!

For over 142 years, **POWER** has been the unwavering pillar of the power and energy industry, offering unparalleled insights on the latest trends, best practices, and news through our robust channels: print, digital media, and in-person events.

SUBSCRIBE NOW 

TRENDING



GAS

How Enagas Turned an Environmental Concern into...



RENEWABLES

Arevon Starts Construction of \$600 Million Cormorant Energ...



NUCLEAR

FluxPoint Energy Enters Race to Build First New U.S.

RECOMMENDED



NEWS

Solar Takes Lead Role in Latest China Five-Year Plan



RENEWABLES

Chile Focuses on Solar and Storage as Generation Capacity Expands



Uranium...



FINANCE
BlackRock's Infrastructure Arm Leads \$250 Million Bet on Commerci...



T&D
Anatomy of a Blackout: Findings from the Spain-Portugal Grid...



NUCLEAR
Nuclear Sprint: DOE and Industry Race to Meet Trump's Target



WORKFORCE
How a University and Industry Partner Are Building...



TRENDS
The Frog Is Dead: North America's Power Grid Faces Its Biggest...



Investments in Renewables Dwarf New Coal, Gas Generation



RENEWABLES
Bechtel Will Build Major Solar and Storage Project in Texas



HYBRID POWER
China Breaks Ground on Massive 16-GW Solar, Wind, Coal Project



China Plans \$363 Billion Investment in Renewables Over Five Years

FROM THE MAGAZINE



HISTORY
Chernobyl at 40: The World's Worst Nuclear Power Accident and Where It Stands Now

[READ THE FULL ISSUE](#) ↻



DATA CENTERS
Full Throttle: Five Trends Reshaping the Gas Power Boom



ELECTRIFICATION
A Powerful Change Supporting Cleaner Energy

POWER

News & Technology for the Global Energy Industry

POWER is at the forefront of the global power market, providing in-depth news and insight on the end-to-end electricity system and the ongoing energy transition. We strive to be the "go-to" resource for power professionals, offering a wealth of information on innovative business practices, sound safety measures, useful productivity enhancements, and much more.

CONNECT: [f](#) [X](#) [in](#)



UPCOMING

Experience POWER

Sept. 28–30, 2026
Omni Shoreham
Washington, D.C.

[LEARN MORE](#) ↻

ABOUT POWER

[Advertise](#) ⚡ [Membership](#) ⚡
[About Us](#) ⚡
[Privacy Policy, Terms & Conditions](#) ⚡
[Diversity, Equity, Inclusion & Belonging](#) ⚡
[Cookie Settings](#) ⚡ [Accessibility](#)

SUBSCRIBE



Membership

Trends, best practices, and news through: print, digital media, and in-person events.
[Subscribe](#) ↻

Newsletters

Exclusive E-letters to
POWER up your knowledge.
[Sign up](#) ✉